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Geographic Applications Branch. GIS Developer (HEO)

Ministry of Defence

Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 16th July 2026



Reference number

468995

Salary

£37,720

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Higher Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

MOD - Military Strategic Headquarters - CSOC - DI - NCGI - DGC

Type of role

Geography
Intelligence

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

5

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Location

RAF Wyton

About the job

Job summary

As an important part of the Ministry of Defence, Defence Intelligence (DI) provides intelligence analysis, specialist outputs and advice that supports decision making across government. At the heart of DI is the National Centre for Geospatial Intelligence (NCGI). The Defence Geographic Centre (DGC) is a unit within NCGI, which delivers geospatial intelligence (GEOINT) and geospatial information (GEOINF) to Defence and is committed to providing comprehensive global geographic support for operations, planning, training and international co-production programmes.

Start your career in geospatial technology with real-world impact

The Geographic Applications Branch (GAB) sits at the heart of the Defence Geographic Centre, helping teams use geospatial technology to support important national work. We design, build and improve the systems and tools that turn data into insight.

As part of the team, you'll work with a mix of modern technologies from commercial software to open-source tools and in-house solutions solving real problems and helping improve how things are done.

We're looking for motivated individuals with an interest in GIS and technology to join us as GIS Developers. You don't need years of experience just curiosity, a willingness to learn, and a passion for problem-solving.

What you can expect:

- Hands-on experience from day one, working on meaningful projects

- Opportunities to learn new tools, develop technical skills, and grow your career

- A supportive team environment where your ideas are valued

- The chance to make a real difference through innovation and continuous improvement

If you enjoy tackling challenges, learning new things, and being part of a team that drives change, this is a great place to build your career.

This role is advertised at 37 hours per week (unless part time)

Job description

Main Responsibilities:

There are five roles available within GAB:

- Cartographic Production Support

- Vector Production Support

- Data Management Support

- Web Tool Development

- Open Source and Online Geospatial Technologies

GAB's prime role is to enable DGC users to operate our geospatial platforms and ensure they have the technical capability to perform data capture, manipulation, curation and provision of Foundation GeoINT to Defence customers and Partners delivering Requests for Information on time, every time.

We do this by working to a continuous integration / continuous deployment (CI/CD) approach ensuring DGC staff have the tools and technical skills by researching commercial software and solutions or developing custom made processes and providing end to end technical support. You will design, build and maintain workflows combining COTS software, Low Code / No Code tools and custom scripts.

The successful candidates will lead a small team responsible for the delivery of set tasks or ad hoc user support. They will be expected to have or develop an in-depth understanding of DGC's Geospatial technology stack (including but not limited to, Esri Enterprise and ArcGIS Pro, SAFE FME), Python programming language, SQL, and AI technologies for increased automation of business processes.

Your day-to-day responsibilities may include:

- Leading on preset tasks improving DGC working practices incorporating project management skills aligned to SAFe Agile.

- Providing technical support to DGC users, maintaining in service systems as requested by user originated Service Desk calls.

- Collaboration with external software vendors.

- Supporting the development of new data exchange formats & metadata requirements.

- Developing new and enhancing existing capabilities employing CI/CD methodologies incorporating modern software engineering practices and tools.

- Meet evolving requirements ensuring that DGC solutions are optimised for the latest technological developments and software.

- Acting as Subject Matter Expertise (SME) for current and future geospatial deliveries.

There may be the opportunity for international travel to attend meetings

In Defence Intelligence (DI) our people solve problems, create understanding and give perspective to the diverse and complex Defence threats and challenges in a rapidly changing world. Together our civilians and military personnel inform decision making in Defence, manage complex finance programmes and develop new technology.

In DI we believe your unique experiences, view and understanding of the world could provide a vital perspective and contribution to our work. We recognise that great minds do not think alike and are striving to increase our diversity representation at all levels. As an equal opportunities employer we hire, train and promote people based on merit and inspire to create an inclusive workplace free of discrimination. We also offer flexible working arrangements such as flexi-time, job share and compressed hours.

All jobs advertised in DI are subject to fair and open competition.

Please note: DGC, MOD Feltham is permanently closing and relocating to RAF Wyton, in line with the scheduled site closure, 31 October 2026.

Existing DGC MOD Feltham candidates that currently have a permanent duty

station at MOD Feltham applying on level transfer or promotion will be entitled to relocation allowances. If the successful candidate is non-mobile, a request must be submitted to the PRIDE2 Change Panel before accepting any provisional offer made.

This position does not come with relocation allowances / support for any non-DGC, MOD Feltham based candidates, or Cross Government candidates or External candidates.

Please be advised that the permanent duty station for this role is RAF Wyton. As part of the PRIDE 2 initiative, MOD Feltham is relocating to RAF Wyton, with the relocation process ongoing until 31 October 2026. All successful candidates are expected to start their positions at RAF Wyton on their agreed start date. For those from DGC MOD Feltham who are successful and eligible for relocation allowances, the business will agree on a start date with you between now and 31 October 2026. However, please note that you must complete your relocation to RAF Wyton by 31 October 2026.

Person specification

We're after someone who is self-motivated, has an inquisitive approach to problem solving, eager to learn, and has a keen eye for detail. You will bring technical skills to continuously improve processes and best practice.

Essential criteria:

Ability to lead a team, setting direction and goals, prioritising work to meet strict deadlines.

Strong attention to detail and the ability to address issues and find innovative solutions for geographic problems with positive, can-do attitude and willingness to learn or adapt.

Ability to work independently and collaboratively to identify inefficiencies in workflows.

Understand and apply industry standards and best practice for scripting and software development principles.

Proficiency in programming languages including Python, HTML, SQL, JavaScript and development.

Understanding of relational databases and data storage.

Desirable criteria:

Knowledge and/or experience in geospatial data, production, analysis and cartographic products.

Proficiency using desktop and web GIS software (ideally ESRI and SAFE).

Awareness of the ITIL Framework and/or AGILE Project Management.

A broad knowledge and understanding of the GEOINT and/or wider intelligence communities.

Candidates are not expected to hold any or all listed qualifications, as relevant experience will be considered equally and training can be provided where required.

GIS certification

IT or Computer Science certification

Python coding language

Chartered Geographer (RGS).

Awareness of the ITIL Framework and/or AGILE Project Management.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Changing and Improving

Making Effective Decisions

Seeing the Big Picture

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Web Enabled Dissemination (DG8.2)

GIS Development and Support (DG9)

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £37,720, Ministry of Defence contributes £10,927 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

We offer a range of excellent benefits including but not limited to the following:

All successful candidates will be eligible to join the Civil Service Pension Scheme with an average employer contribution of 28%.

Leave entitlement - 25-day annual leave allowance per year increasing by 1 day per year (maximum 30 days per year). In addition, 8 statutory Bank Holidays and 1 privilege day per year.

Complementing our generous annual leave allowance, we also have a flexible working scheme.

Additional working pattern options we have a strong culture of flexible working and encourage all employees to have a healthy work/life balance. We offer a wide range of potential working patterns, including part time, job share and compressed hours. These need to be balanced with business needs so they will vary from job to job. If you would like to know more, please speak to the Recruiting Line Manager.

Professional Development - We are committed to your continued professional and personal development with learning as one of our core values.

Health and Wellbeing for a small fee we offer the staff the use of the exceptional site gymnasium facilities.

We also offer an excellent range of family-friendly benefits, for example, enhanced maternity, paternity and adoption leave.

Special Paid Leave to volunteer up to 6 days a year

RAF Wyton has free car parking; and other facilities such as a Sports & Social Club, Gym and onsite shop.

This post does not offer any assistance with relocation allowances; however, some applicants may be eligible to claim Apprentice Living Away from Home Allowance.

Discover My Benefits

Please follow the link to visit the Discover My Benefits site which showcases the benefits and discounts offered when working as a civilian for the MOD.

<https://discovermybenefits.mod.gov.uk/civilian/>

Please Note: Expenses incurred for travel to interviews will not be reimbursed.

Please be advised that the Department is conducting a review of all pay related allowances which could impact on those allowances that the post currently being advertised attracts.

Any move to MOD from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax-Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at <https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk/>.

The Ministry of Defence is committed to providing a safe and healthy working environment for its staff which includes educating them on the benefits of not smoking, protecting them from the harmful effects of second-hand smoke and supporting those who want to give up smoking. Under the Smoke-Free Working Environment policy, Smoking and the use of all tobacco products (including combustible and chewing tobacco products) will not be permitted anywhere in the Defence working environment however some exemptions are in place, please refer to local guidance. The policy is Whole Force and includes all Defence personnel, contractors, visitors and other non-MOD personnel. All applicants seeking, considering, or accepting employment with the Ministry of Defence should be aware of this policy and that it is already in place at a number of Defence Establishments.

MOD Recruitment Satisfaction Survey We may contact you regarding your experience to help us improve our customer satisfaction. The survey is voluntary and anonymous. You may however be given the opportunity to provide additional information to help us improve our service which includes the collection of some personal data as defined by the United Kingdom General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR). The [MOD Privacy Policy Notice](#) sets out how we will use your personal data and your rights.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Assessment at sift and interview will be based on meeting any defined skill/qualification requirements along with a Success Profile element assessment, as detailed in the job advert. The Success Profile elements to be assessed will be outlined within the job advert. The Civil Service Success Profile Framework is available here:

<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/success-profiles>

At sift, applicants will be sifted against their experience and skills criteria defined in the Person Specification by way of a personal statement. It will explain how your knowledge, experience and skills, relevant to the purpose and main objectives of this role, have been applied to achieve outcomes. The selection panel will use your Personal Statement to assess your potential suitability for this role.

Experience:

All applicants will need to provide a personal statement, of no more than 750 words, including evidence of the essential and desirable criteria requested within the job advert.

When completing your personal statement, please read and understand the requirements described in the Person Specification section thoroughly, as this is what your written evidence will be assessed against.

Your layout is entirely your preference; you may choose narrative, bullets, etc. You may choose to address each criteria separately or have examples that cover and evidence several criteria. Please ensure you evidence the requirements and what you have done that relates to the requirements. You don't have to explain the whole process, focus on what you have done and the skills and experience you have used. Share with us what makes you suited to this role and why, what you can do and the technical and behavioural skills you have that correspond to the requirements, and life experience or passion you have that are linked to this role.

At **interview**, applicants will be sifted against the following Civil Service Behaviours and/or Technical skills and will also be asked to complete an exercise to assess proficiency with Python:

Behaviours (Level 3 for HEO):

- Seeing the Big Picture
- Changing and Improving
- Making Effective Decisions

Technical skills (Senior Practitioner):

- Defence Geographer framework
- 8.2 Web Enabled Dissemination
- 9 GIS Development and Support

In Tray Exercise:

- Python coding exercise

This exercise will include a series of questions to assess your knowledge and experience of using and scripting in python. All equipment required will be provide for you.

We would generally expect Behaviour examples to follow the STAR structure and encourage candidates to use this throughout their application.

Application/Interview Scoring System

NCGI adopts a scoring system of 1-7 for Behaviours, Technical skills, and Experience.

7- The evidence provided wholly exceeds expectation at this level

6 - Substantial positive evidence; includes some evidence of exceeding expectations at this level

5 - Substantial positive evidence of the competency or behaviour

4 - Adequate positive evidence and any negative evidence would not cause concern

3 - Moderate positive evidence but some negative evidence demonstrated

2 - Limited positive evidence and/or mainly negative evidence demonstrated

1 - No positive evidence and/or substantial negative evidence demonstrated

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

If the successful candidate does not hold the necessary clearances, they will be made a provisional job offer and asked to undergo our vetting procedures. Once the relevant clearances have been obtained a formal job offer will be made and start dates can be discussed. Should the candidate fail to obtain the relevant clearances the provisional job offer will be rescinded. It should be noted that this process can take several months.

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

There may be occasions where it is not practicable or appropriate to interview all DCS candidates that meet the minimum criteria for the job. For example, in certain recruitment situations such as a high volume of applications,

seasonal demand, or peak periods, the employer may wish to limit the overall number of interviews offered to both DCS and non-DCS applicants.

As a result of the changes to the UK immigration rules which came into effect on 1 January 2021, the Ministry of Defence will only offer sponsorship for a skilled worker visa under the points-based system, where a role has been deemed to be business critical. This role does not meet that category, and we will not sponsor a visa. It is therefore NOT open to applications from those who will require sponsorship under the points-based system.

Should you apply for this role and be found to require sponsorship, your application will be rejected and any provisional offer of employment withdrawn.

The Ministry of Defence requires all candidates who are successful at interview to declare any outside interests. These declarations will be discussed with successful candidates following the interview process and before a formal offer of employment is made, as some outside interests may not be compatible with MOD civilian roles. This will not, in the majority of cases, prevent employment in MOD, but it is a measure that must be taken to ensure that appropriate mitigations can be put in place to manage any potential, perceived or actual conflicts of interest from the first day of employment.

The Ministry of Defence adopts a zero-tolerance approach to unacceptable behaviours, which includes bullying, harassment, sexual harassment, discrimination, and victimisation. You will not be eligible and will not be considered for this post if you have been dismissed from a role for such unacceptable behaviours within the last five years. This will also apply if you resign or otherwise leave a role but, because of an adverse decision, would have been dismissed for gross misconduct had you continued in that employment. Pre-employment checks will be carried out.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [developed vetting \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

Open to UK nationals only.

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : NCGI Recruitment Team

Email : UKStratCom-DI-NCGI-Recruitment@mod.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : DBSCivPers-ResourcingTeam3@mod.gov.uk

Further information

Please ensure you read the attached candidate information document prior to completing your application. If you are dissatisfied with the service you have received from DBS, or believe that DBS has failed to follow the recruitment process in line with the Civil Service Commission principles of selection for appointment on merit on the basis of Fair and Open competition, you can raise a formal complaint by writing to DBS at the following address: Defence Business Services, Scanning Hub, Room 6124, Tomlinson House, Norcross Lane, Blackpool, FY5 3WP. If after raising your complaint with DBS you remain dissatisfied you can complain directly to the Civil Service Commission at the following address: Civil Service commission, Room G/8, 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ Or by email: info@csc.gov.uk.

